



NEWSLETTER

Monthly News Digest
No.6/June 2025

Main Stories: Athlete and mentor completed leadership training, Unified Football Refresher Coach trained 25 new coaches, and SOPNG and partners advocate for inclusion.

Athlete and mentor completed leadership training

Special Olympics Papua New Guinea proudly congratulates Athlete Leader Pauline Paul and her mentor Ectopia Ame on successfully completing the Unified Leadership Academy Level III, held in Singapore from June 1–4.

Hosted by Special Olympics Asia Pacific, this event marked the duo's third consecutive year of participating in the Academy, a training program designed to strengthen inclusive leadership and enhance organizational sustainability among athlete leaders, mentors, and Special Olympics staff at both program and regional levels.

Pauline and Ectopia's dedication over the past three years reflects their unwavering commitment to advancing leadership excellence and inclusion within the global Special Olympics movement.

Their journey is an inspiring example of how athlete leaders and mentors can shape a more unified and empowered future for all.



From Right: Mentor Ectopia Ame, Athlete Leader Pauline Paul and other participants participating in the Leadership Academy 3 training.



Mentor Ectopia and Athlete Leader Pauline.

The duo participating during the training.

Unified Refresher Course prepares coaches for August competition

Special Olympics Papua New Guinea (SOPNG) successfully hosted a two-day Unified Football Refresher Course at John Guise Stadium, training 25 new coaches from primary schools, inclusive schools, and communities in the National Capital District and Central Province.

The training aimed to equip coaches with both theoretical knowledge and practical skills in coaching Unified Football, a program that brings together athletes with and without intellectual disabilities, ahead of the upcoming competition in August.

SOPNG extends its gratitude to the Papua New Guinea Football Association (PNGFA) for their collaborative support in building the capacity of our coaches.

Special thanks also go to Moniplus PNG Limited for their generous sponsorship, which made this training possible, and to the PNG Sports Foundation's Venue Management Team for their continuous and steadfast support.

The course was facilitated by PNGFA Coach David Muta and SOPNG Head Coach Jenny Sike, with the assistance of youth volunteers Eunice Wanjumoe and Jeremiah Elizah. Following the training, the newly certified coaches have been tasked with preparing athletes in their respective schools and communities, ensuring they are competition-ready in August.



Participants group photo for day one of the Unified Refresher Course training.



Participants group photo for day two of the Unified Refresher Course training.

Main Stories: Athlete and mentor completed leadership training, Unified Football Refresher Coach trained 25 new coaches, and SOPNG and partners advocate for inclusion.

Day 1: Introduction to Special Olympics and Unified Sports Coaching Courses

The training, held on June 7, covered a range of important topics including the Special Olympics Sports Rules, the Roles and Responsibilities of Coaches, Nutrition and Hydration, and the History of Special Olympics.

Coaches were also introduced to the Special Olympics online learning portal, where they registered to complete three key coaching courses: Coaching Assistant Level 1, Coaching Assistant Level 2, and the Unified Sports Coaching Course.

Upon completion, participants received electronic certificates for each course.

These online modules play a vital role in helping coaches better understand divisioning criteria and ensure fair and inclusive competition in Special Olympics events.



Coach Jenny taking the new coaches into their roles and responsibilities.

Day 2: Coaches trained in practical session with PNGFA

The second day of training, held on June 21, marked a significant collaboration with PNGFA, which led the session.

Coach David Muta delivered a comprehensive program combining both theory and practical components, utilizing Oceania Football Confederation (OFC) resource materials.

The session introduced participants to the Football Basic Coaching Course, aimed at equipping new coaches with the foundational skills needed to deliver effective and inclusive training sessions for players of all abilities.

A key highlight of the day was a group activity in which coaches were divided into teams and tasked with planning a sample football training session.

Following group discussions, each team moved to the field to demonstrate their planned sessions in an outdoor practical.

Core elements emphasized during the session included training duration, number of players, required equipment, warm-up routines, main training activities, cool-down techniques, and post-session evaluation.



Participants in groups demonstrating their sample training sessions.



PNGFA Coach David Muta (in front) delivering the session.

SOPNG and partners advocate for inclusion

On June 18, Special Olympics Papua New Guinea (SOPNG) volunteers Eunice Wanjumoe and Shonaye Leslie proudly represented the organization at an inclusive awareness event held at the Hilton Hotel in Port Moresby.

The duo delivered a compelling presentation showcasing SOPNG's ongoing efforts to promote inclusion and empower individuals with disabilities across Papua New Guinea.

Their presentation highlighted the critical role of inclusive sports, education, and community engagement in breaking down barriers and fostering a society where everyone belongs.

The event featured several key highlights:

A thought-provoking presentation on Inclusive Education by Coach Jenny Sike of PNG Red Cross;

Interactive Sign Language training facilitated by the Callan Services team;

Inclusive group activities that emphasized the message that inclusion is not merely symbolic, it is an ongoing, shared responsibility.

SOPNG extends its sincere appreciation to Badminton PNG, Interplast Australia & New Zealand, and all participating athletes and stakeholders for their continued support and commitment. Your advocacy and collaboration are vital in advancing our mission to build inclusive opportunities where every person, regardless of ability, is empowered to participate and thrive.

Together, we are shaping a more inclusive and compassionate Papua New Guinea



Volunteers Eunice and Shonaye delivering the presentation about the work of SOPNG



(Right) Head Coach Jenny and explaining to the participants, including some athletes from Paralympics standing on left.



Participants team up for a group photo.